

Radical Chains (Marx on Freedom and Determinism)

If Marx's and Engels's materialist conception of history entails that human behavior is strictly deterministic and that socialism is guaranteed by the inexorable march of history, then it would seem to follow that human beings are not and could not be "free" in the way that the practice of moral judgment generally presupposes them to be. When we deem a person to be morally responsible—that is, to be the appropriate object of moral praise or blame—we generally presume that they have, in some deep sense, *chosen* to act as they did. We presuppose that they are the author of the event in question.

Strict determinism has it that actions which might seem at first blush to be "mine" in some deep sense were in fact fatalistically preordained by circumstances preceding even my very existence. "My" decisions would for that reason then be quite out of my control and not properly attributable to *me*, after all. A Marxist moral theory owes to its hearers an explanation of how it is that historical materialism is not strict determinism of this kind, a further explanation of what kind of determinism historical materialism *does* entail, and an account of how this can be compatible with the human emancipation Marx repeatedly identifies as the chief aim of socialist praxis.

If Marx's economic determinism requires that individual human beings always only behave just as the "laws of history" unavoidably compel them to, then moral praise and blame is no more appropriately applied to them than it is to inanimate objects dropped from heights. Numerous interpreters of Marx, presuming that historical materialism does entail a strict, mechanistic determinism, have gone on to reason that Marx's theory is therefore inhospitable to morality. However, historical materialism does not entail this.

We might here be appropriately reminded of Marx's oft-quoted observation that "men make their own history, but they do not make it as they please; they do not make it under self-selected circumstances, but under circumstances existing already, given and transmitted from the past."¹ What

5 条激进链条（马克思论自由与决定论）

如果马克思和恩格斯的历史唯物主义意味着人类行为是严格决定论的，且社会主义由历史不可抗拒的进程所保证，那么似乎可以推论出，人类并不，也不可能以道德判断实践通常预设的方式成为“自由”的。当我们判定一个人具有道德责任——即成为道德赞扬或谴责的适当对象时——我们通常预设他们在某种深层意义上选择那样行事。我们预设他们是所涉事件的作者。

严格决定论认为，那些乍看之下在某种深层意义上似乎是“我的”行动，实际上是由甚至在我存在之前就已存在的条件宿命论式地预先注定的。因此，“我的”决定在那种意义上完全不受我控制，归根结底不能归因于我。马克思主义道德理论向其听众有义务解释历史唯物主义为何不是这种严格决定论，进一步说明历史唯物主义实际上蕴含何种决定论，并阐述这如何能与马克思反复指出的社会主义实践的首要目标——人类解放——相兼容。

如果马克思的经济决定论要求人类个体总是仅仅像“历史规律”不可避免地将他们推动的那样行动，那么道德赞扬和谴责对他们来说，并不比对从高处坠落的无生命物体更恰当。许多马克思的阐释者假定历史唯物主义 **entails** 一种严格的机械决定论，进而推论马克思的理论因此对道德是不友好的。然而，历史唯物主义并不 **entail** 这一点。

我们或许在此恰当地想起马克思那句常被引用的观察：“人们自己创造自己的历史，但是他们并不是随心所欲地创造，并不是在他们自己选定的条件下创造，而是在直接碰到的、既定的、从过去承继下来的条件下创造。”¹ 这

is meant by that famous line from Marx's 1852 *Eighteenth Brumaire of Louis Bonaparte*? For one thing, it expresses that human social existence is the product of human labor, and as such, it is susceptible to human intervention aimed at making it over and (re-)directing its course. I argue this principle is absolutely central to Marx's moral thought. Any given individual human being, while alienated from their human powers, has relatively little in the way of genuine authorship over their actions or even their entire lives, but not exactly none. By contrast, at the level of the species, it can be said that humanity truly is the author of its actions, and of the course of its own history. This is true even if only unconsciously so, and in an attenuated fashion prior to the realization of full human emancipation in fully developed communism.

Both Marx and Engels insist on multiple occasions that humanity itself is a human product.² However, "humanity" is an abstraction. To satisfy ourselves with the explanation that "humanity" is free in the desired sense (even while individual human beings are not) would be to content ourselves with a resolution of the antagonism between freedom and determinism that occurs only in the realm of thought. Yet our aim is not merely to discover a clever solution to a philosophical puzzle. It is rather to ascertain how this kind of self-making can be manifested by individual human beings, so that a given individual might more truly be said to be the author of her actions.

As such, the discussion of freedom and determinism in Marx is highly interwoven with our understanding of Marx's concept of the individual. For purposes of clarity and presentation, I treat these subjects in two separate chapters. (Chapter 6, "Individuality," directly follows the present one.) Here, I will set the stage for understanding the reconciliation of freedom and determinism in Marxist thought, but it will be more fully transparent once we've considered Marx's view of individuality. An explanation of the relationship between freedom and determinism in Marx's thought, and that of the relationship between individual and society, outline in parallel the same historical process through which human emancipation becomes realized.

In order to help orient our discussion, it is useful to say a bit about how Marx's proffered resolution to the antagonism between freedom and determinism relates to the positions that many readers will recognize as familiar from traditional Anglophone philosophy. "Incompatibilism" is the name given to views that hold freedom to be untenable in the presence of determinism. "Compatibilist" views maintain that this pair can coexist. If we were to map Marx's positions onto Anglophone/analytical-philosophical

究竟是指马克思1852年《路易·波拿巴的雾月十八日》中的那句名言吗？一方面，它表达了人类社会存在是人类劳动的产物，因此，它容易受到旨在改造和（重新）引导其进程的人类干预的影响。我认为这一原则对马克思的道德思想至关重要。任何给定的个人，尽管与人类力量相异化，对其行为乃至其整个生活拥有相对较少的真正的作者身份，但并非完全没有。相比之下，在物种层面上，可以说人类确实是其行动及其自身历史进程的创造者。即使这种创造只是无意识的，并且是在充分的人类解放尚未在充分发展的共产主义中实现之前的微弱形式，这一事实依然成立。

马克思和恩格斯在多个场合都坚持认为，人类本身是人类的产物。² 然而，“人类”是一个抽象概念。满足于“人类”在所需意义上是自由的（尽管个人并非如此）这一解释，就意味着满足于一种仅在思维领域中解决的自由与决定论之间的对抗。然而，我们的目标不仅仅是发现一个解决哲学谜题的巧妙方案。我们更是要弄清这种自我创造如何在个人身上体现，从而使我们可以更真实地说，某个特定的个人是她自己行动的作者。

因此，马克思关于自由与决定论的讨论与我们对马克思个人概念的理解紧密交织。为了清晰和呈现的需要，我将这两个主题分在两个独立的章节中讨论。（第6章“个体性”直接紧随本章。）在这里，我将为理解马克思主义思想中自由与决定论的调和奠定基础，但一旦我们考察了马克思关于个体性的观点，这一理解将更加透明。对马克思思想中自由与决定论关系的解释，以及对个人与社会关系的阐述，平行地勾勒出人类解放得以实现的历史进程。

为了帮助引导我们的讨论，简要说明马克思提出的关于自由与决定论之间对抗的解决方案，如何与许多读者从传统英语哲学中熟悉的立场相关联，是有益的。“不兼容论”是指那些认为在决定论存在的情况下自由不可行的观点。“相容论者”观点则主张这一对概念可以共存。如果我们试图将马克思的立场映射到英语/分析哲学

perspectives on the matter, then Marx is a compatibilist about freedom and determinism.

However, such a mapping must remain purely heuristic. If taken too literally, it will obscure what Marx takes to be two of the most important distinctions between historical materialism and the worldviews he associates with ideologically “bourgeois” approaches. Namely, one must not overlook the deep extent to which on a Marxist approach to thinking through freedom, agency, morality, and necessity, the precise relationship between freedom and determinism can be given no static or permanent description.

This antagonism is one that shifts dynamically over the course of human history, with each side of the contradiction conditioning and transforming the development of the other. There is no fixed and final answer to the question of how human freedom can exist in the presence of deterministic laws. This relationship is not a puzzle to be contemplated in thought, but a problem to be worked out concretely in the course of history. What’s more, the impetus for this development is provided by human action, itself both free and determined.

Here, I use the term “dialectical compatibilism” to invoke both the ways in which Marx’s approach to freedom and determinism is in conversation with traditional analyses of this pairing, and also the ways in which it is fundamentally divergent from them.³ This position moves beyond the views typically arrayed along the axes of determinist or libertarian, compatibilist or incompatibilist. Much of the confusion surrounding Marx’s positions on the relationship between freedom and determinism stems from the fact that for Marx this is an evolving and historically contingent relationship. One cannot issue timeless, universal statements about the degree to which external determining factors influence human behavior, or concerning the extent to which this behavior is the free and voluntary action of human beings.

It is true that humans have acted under conditions that, speaking for the most part, they have not chosen. Yet in so doing, they also bring those conditions increasingly under their conscious control. As humans develop greater control over their circumstances, they correspondingly broaden their capacity for free, self-directed agency. In this way, on Marx’s account, freedom and determinism conflict with one another much as they do on the most well-known “incompatibilist” accounts. Yet deterministic economic forces also function as preconditions for human freedom and figure into the story of how that freedom comes about. Marx’s picture is not of a compatibility between freedom and determinism that holds true in precisely the same

视角上关于这一问题的看法，那么马克思就是关于自由与决定论的相容论者。

然而，这种映射必须保持纯粹的启发式。如果过于字面地理解，它将模糊马克思所认为的历史唯物主义与他所关联的在意识形态上“资产阶级的”世界观之间的两个最重要区别。也就是说，在马克思主义的视角下思考自由、能动性、道德和必然性时，绝不能忽视自由与决定论之间精确关系的深度，这种关系无法被给予任何静态或永久的描述。

这种对抗随着人类历史的发展而动态变化，矛盾的每一方都在塑造和转化着另一方的发展。关于人类自由如何在决定论法则存在的情况下存在，没有固定和最终的答案。这种关系不是一个在思想中沉思的谜题，而是一个在历史进程中具体解决的难题。此外，这种发展的动力来自于人类行动本身，它既是自由的又是被决定的。

在此，我使用“辩证相容论”一词，既是为了唤起马克思关于自由与决定论的方法与传统对该配对的分析之间的对话方式，也是为了表明它在根本上与它们相背离。³ 这一立场超越了通常沿着决定论者或自由意志论者、相容论者或不相容论者轴线排列的观点。围绕马克思关于自由与决定论之间关系的立场的许多混淆，源于马克思认为这是一种演变的、具有历史偶然性的关系。人们不能就外部决定因素在多大程度上影响人类行为，或就这种行为在多大程度上是人类行为的自由和自愿行动，发布永恒的、普遍的论断。

诚然，人类是在很大程度上未曾选择的条件下行动的。然而，正是在这样做时，他们也越来越将这些条件置于有意识的控制之下。随着人类对其环境获得更大的控制，他们相应地扩大了自由、自我导向的能动性能力。以马克思的观点来看，在这种方式下，自由与决定论之间的冲突正如在众所周知的“不相容论者”观点中那样。然而，决定性的经济力量同时也作为人类自由的前提条件发挥作用，并构成了自由如何产生的故事的一部分。马克思的图景并非自由与决定论之间在任何时间和空间对所有人类都同样成立的相容性，

way for all humans across time and space, but rather of a human freedom that grows, spurred in part by the operation of deterministic laws. In human activity, freedom and determinism are mutually conditioned in ways that produce their ever-greater dialectical compatibility, unfolding across time.

Karl Popper, whose influence in the Anglophone reception of Marx has been unfortunately large, writes that Marx adhered “to the false belief that a rigidly scientific method must be based on a rigid determinism.”⁴ Indeed, it has become something like conventional wisdom that Marx subscribed to a crude economic determinism that would make human freedom unintelligible. This view of Marx usually rules out, or at least declares incoherent and unintelligible, any genuinely moral content in his work. Hence, one work in micro-economics could claim that Marx’s “economic determinism had consequences for the picture of human beings in Marxist theory, and for the freedom of action of economically acting individuals. They have no autonomy of action, they only carry out economic laws.”⁵ And Jules Townshend in his 1996 book *The Politics of Marxism: The Critical Debates*, could write,

a potential conflict arose between Marx’s economic determinism and his idea of human agency, which allowed individuals, and particularly classes, a certain autonomy of action, through ‘practical-critical’ activity. Marx’s idea that communism was inevitable permitted him to avoid the question of whether it was morally desirable. . . . Yet what if the determinist theory, upon which this ‘inevitability’ rested, was flawed? Would this not then put the moral appeal of socialism centre stage?⁶

In a similar vein, Eugene Kamenka, in *The Ethical Foundations of Marxism*, argued that Marx did not see the proletariat as an active force in society, and instead

stuck to his negative view of the proletariat as the *most suffering class* . . . Marx chose to rely on “history,” to hold out to the proletariat the vision of a classless society *made safe* for goods, where enterprise and freedom would be *guaranteed* by the economic foundations of society itself, where freedom would not lie in struggle, but follow from mere existence.

Kamenka writes that this conception had a “servile character,” and that in following Marx, “Marxists were upholding a servile and unfree morality.”⁷

而是一种人类自由，它部分由决定论法则的运作所推动而不断增长。在人类活动中，自由与决定论以相互制约的方式存在，从而产生其日益增强的辩证兼容性，并在时间中展开。

卡尔·波普尔在英语世界的接受中对马克思的影响不幸地巨大，他写道，马克思坚持“一种错误的信念，即严格科学的方法必须基于严格决定论”。⁴ 确实，人们普遍认为马克思信奉一种粗糙的经济决定论，这种决定论使得人类自由变得不可理解。这种对马克思的看法通常排除，或至少宣布其工作中任何真正的道德内容是不连贯且不可理解的。因此，微观经济学中有一项工作声称，马克思的“经济决定论对马克思主义理论中的人类图景以及经济行动者的行动自由产生了影响。他们没有行动自主性，只是执行经济规律”。⁵ 朱尔斯·汤申德在其1996年的著作《马克思主义的政治学：关键辩论》中写道，

马克思的经济决定论与他关于人类能动性的思想之间产生了一种潜在冲突，后者允许个人，特别是阶级，通过‘实践-批判’活动拥有一定的行动自主性。马克思认为共产主义是必然的，这使他得以回避共产主义是否在道德上可取的问题。……然而，如果这一‘必然性’所依赖的决定论理论存在缺陷呢？这难道不会将社会主义的道德吸引力置于核心地位吗？⁶

与此类似，尤金·卡门卡在《马克思主义的伦理基础》中认为，马克思并未将无产阶级视为社会中的积极力量，而是

坚持他对无产阶级作为最受苦阶级的负面看法……马克思选择依赖“历史”，向无产阶级描绘一个无阶级社会的愿景，该社会能保障商品安全，其中企业精神和自由将由社会本身的经济基础所保障，自由并非源于斗争，而是源于单纯的存在。

卡门卡写道，这种观念具有“奴性特征”，并且追随马克思的“马克思主义者维护的是一种奴性且不自由的道德”。⁷

It is, as we will find, an oversimplification to understand Marx's comments about the role of economic laws in shaping the prospects for and likelihood of communism as though they simply participate in a balancing act between the twin poles of deterministic inevitability and abstract moralistic voluntarism. It is a still more grave vulgarization to suggest that it collapses entirely into the mechanistic determinism Marx explicitly rejected.

Willis H. Truitt, in his 2005 book *Marxist Ethics: A Short Exposition*, wittily remarks on the critical reception of Marx's historical materialism: "It is odd that the issue of determinism in Marx should be brought up at this late stage of the development of Marxist thought. One might even suspect that all these years of academic anti-Marxist indoctrination which teaches that historical materialism is a deterministic system has worked."⁸

A final note before we proceed: although I speak here of "freedom," I do not argue that Marx defended the existence of "free will." In fact, he did not, and his references to free will are nearly always ironic. By "free will," Marx understood the self-determining, spontaneous, autonomous, cause of human actions that figures in the moral theory of philosophers such as Immanuel Kant. But Marx writes of Kant:

Neither he, nor the German middle class, whose whitewashing spokesman he was, noticed that these theoretical ideas of the bourgeoisie had as their basis material interests and a *will* that was conditioned and determined by the material relations of production. Kant, therefore, separated this theoretical expression from the interests which it expressed; he made the materially motivated determinations of the will of the French bourgeois into pure self-determinations of "free will," of the will in and for itself, of the human will, and so converted it into purely ideological conceptual determinations and moral postulates.⁹

In *Capital*, Marx describes the worker as "the man who is compelled to sell himself of his own free will"; here, too, his words drip with irony.¹⁰ Freedom in Marxist theory has little to do with the kind of spontaneity that requires we posit the will as an ideal/spiritual substance, wholly undetermined by material causes. It has much more in common with what Hegel, in *The Philosophy of Right*, calls "concrete freedom." Hegel writes,

concrete freedom requires that personal individuality and its particular interests should reach their full *development* and gain *recognition of their*

正如我们将发现的那样，将马克思关于经济规律在塑造共产主义前景和可能性中的作用所作的评论，简单理解为在决定论的必然性与抽象道德唯意志论这两个对立极点之间进行的平衡，这是一种过度简化。更严重的是庸俗化，即暗示这种观点完全陷入了马克思明确拒绝的机械决定论。

威利斯·H·特鲁特在其2005年出版的《马克思主义伦理学：简短阐述》一书中，机智地评论了马克思历史唯物主义所受到的批判性接受：“令人奇怪的是，在马克思主义思想发展的这一后期阶段，竟然有人提出马克思的决定论问题。人们甚至可能会怀疑，多年来关于历史唯物主义是决定论体系的学术反马克思主义灌输是否已经奏效。”⁸

在继续之前作最后说明：尽管我在此处谈论“自由”，但我并不认为马克思捍卫了“自由意志”的存在。事实上，他并未如此，他对自由意志的提及几乎总是反讽的。马克思所理解的“自由意志”，是指像伊曼努尔·康德等哲学家道德理论中所描述的那种自我决定、自发、自主的人类行为原因。但马克思在谈及康德时写道：

无论是他本人，还是他所粉饰的德国中产阶级，都没有注意到，资产阶级的这些理论观念是以物质利益为基础的，其意志是由生产物质关系所制约和决定的。因此，康德将这种理论表达与它所表达的利益分离开来；他将法国资产阶级的、由物质动机所决定的意志规定，转化为“自由意志”的纯粹自我规定，转化为意志本身和为自身的意志，即人类意志，从而将其转化为纯粹的意识形态概念决定和道德公设。⁹

在《资本论》中，马克思将工人描述为“一个被迫出于自由意志而出卖自己的人”；在这里，他的话语同样充满讽刺。马克思主义理论中的自由与那种要求我们将意志设定为一种完全不受物质原因决定的理想/精神实体的自发性几乎没有关系。它更多地与黑格尔在《法哲学原理》中所称的“具体自由”相一致。黑格尔写道，

具体自由要求个人个性及其特殊利益应得到充分发展并获得对其

right for itself . . . and also that they should, on the one hand, *pass over* of their own accord into the interest of the universal, and on the other, knowingly and willingly acknowledge this universal interest even as their own *substantial spirit*, and *actively pursue it* as their *ultimate end*.¹¹

It would be a facile error simply to translate Hegel's terms into "materialist" concepts, in order to arrive at a Marxist concept of freedom. However, it is nonetheless illuminating to note here how little this kind of freedom has to do with the undetermined free will. This view of freedom is best expressed as a proliferation and mastery of one's own powers, a kind of individual flourishing that is made fully possible only in and through one's unalienated relationship to the species. Marx alludes to this in the *1844 Manuscripts*, where he writes,

Just as through the movement of private property, of its wealth as well as its poverty—of its material and spiritual wealth and poverty—the budding society finds at hand all the material for this development, so established society produces man in this entire richness of his being—produces the rich man profoundly endowed with all the senses—as its enduring reality. We see how subjectivity and objectivity, spirituality and materiality, activity and suffering, lose their antithetical character, and thus their existence as such antitheses only within the framework of society; we see how the resolution of the theoretical antitheses is only possible in a practical way, by virtue of the practical energy of man. Their resolution is therefore by no means merely a problem of understanding, but a real problem of life, which philosophy could not solve precisely because it conceived this problem as merely a theoretical one.¹²

I give the name "dialectical compatibilism" to that view. Human beings are compelled to act so as to satisfy their needs within circumstances that they cannot fully control. But in so doing, they are determined—by biological need and by external circumstances—to respond to their need and their circumstances in ways that, in turn, expand their capacities to intervene into the world around them and direct its processes. They gain greater freedom precisely as a result of the deterministic forces to which they are subjected.¹³ Human freedom is itself a human product, one that emerges gradually over the course of history out of human beings' goal-directed interactions with their natural and social environment. There is no inconsistency in Marx

权利的承认……同时，一方面，它们应自愿地转向普遍利益，另一方面，有意识地并自愿地承认这一普遍利益作为其自身的实质精神，并主动将其作为最终目标加以追求。¹¹

若仅仅为了得出一种马克思主义的自由概念，便轻率地将黑格尔的术语翻译成“唯物”概念，那将是一个肤浅的错误。然而，在此指出这种自由与未受决定的自由意志之间关联甚微，仍颇具启发意义。这种自由观最好被表述为对自身力量的增殖与掌控，一种只有通过物种的异化前关系才能完全实现的个人繁荣。马克思在《1844年手稿》中对此有所暗示，他写道，

正如通过私有财产的运动——包括其财富及其贫困——即其物质和精神财富与贫困——萌芽中的社会找到了这一发展所需的全部物质资料一样，既定的社会也在此人的全部丰富性中生产人——生产出拥有所有感官的丰富的人——作为其持久的现实。我们看到，主观性与客观性、精神性与物质性、活动与苦难，如何失去了它们的对立特征，因此它们作为对立面的存在仅存在于社会的框架之内；我们看到，理论对立面的解决只能通过实践的方式，凭借人的实践能量而成为可能。因此，它们的解决绝非仅仅是一个理解问题，而是一个真实的生活问题，哲学之所以无法解决它，正是因为它将这一问题仅仅视为理论问题。¹²

我将这种观点命名为“辩证相容论”。人类被迫在无法完全掌控的环境中行动，以满足其需求。但正是在这样做时，他们受到生物需求和外部环境的决定，以回应其需求和环境的方式，反过来又扩展了他们干预周围世界并引导其进程的能力。他们获得的自由恰恰正是源于他们所受的决定论力量。¹³人类自由本身是人类的产品，是在历史进程中逐渐从人类与其自然和社会环境的有目的互动中产生的。马克思在描述人类行为相对规律的、决定论规律的同时，又谈论人类自由、个体性和创造潜能的蓬勃发展，这之间并无不一致。

describing fairly law-like, deterministic regularities of human behavior on the one hand and speaking of a flourishing of human freedom, individuality, and creative potential on the other. If determinism is the negation of real human agency, then human freedom is the negation of that negation, one that can emerge only in the course of history.

In the following sections of this chapter, I trace Marx's treatment of the relationship between freedom and determinism. I consider how his approach to theorizing that relationship developed over the course of his life, with special attention paid to his doctoral dissertation on Democritus and Epicurus, the *Communist Manifesto*, and *Capital*.

Marx on “the Difference Between the Democritean and the Epicurean Philosophy of Nature”

Marx's doctoral dissertation is also an early treatment by Marx of the relationship between freedom and necessity, and an examination of the ontological status of abstract objects. Here, Marx studies the differences between the atomistic physical theories of the ancient Greek materialist philosophers, Democritus and Epicurus. Marx defends Epicurus against the charge leveled against him by Cicero, Leibniz, and others, that he is little more than a poor plagiarist of Democritus, arguing that not only does Epicurus make unique philosophical contributions of his own, but that his physical theory represents a theoretical advance beyond Democritean atomism. This advance consists partly in Epicurean physics' avoidance of the strict mechanistic determinism that is a hallmark of Democritus's view. On that basis, Marx credits Epicurus with formulating a materialist worldview that can accommodate freedom.

To understand the relationship between Marx's study of ancient Greek atomistics and his views on the relationship between freedom and determinism, it will be first necessary to introduce the physical systems of Democritus and Epicurus in a bit of detail.

Democritus argued that the fundamental physical structure of matter is composed of atoms—small, indivisible particles—that move in straight lines. The motion of atoms in Democritean physics is determined entirely by external forces on them. They move, impelled by the downward pull of gravity or by the force of collisions between atoms. Epicurus adopted the framework of Democritean atomism, with the following notable alteration: atoms did not simply move in a straight line, the path of which was strictly determined

如果决定论是对真正人类能动性的否定，那么人类自由就是对这种否定的否定，它只能在历史进程中产生。

在本章的以下部分，我梳理了马克思关于自由与决定论之间关系的论述。我考察了他在其一生中发展这一关系理论的方法，特别关注他的德谟克利特与伊壁鸠鲁博士论文、《共产党宣言》和《资本论》。

马克思论“德谟克利特与伊壁鸠鲁自然哲学的差异”

马克思的博士论文也是马克思早期关于自由与必然之间关系的论述，以及对抽象对象本体论地位的考察。在此，马克思研究了古希腊唯物主义哲学家德谟克利特和伊壁鸠鲁的原子论物理理论之间的差异。马克思为伊壁鸠鲁辩护，反驳西塞罗、莱布尼茨等人对他的指责，即伊壁鸠鲁不过是一个拙劣的德谟克利特抄袭者，论证伊壁鸠鲁不仅做出了自己独特的哲学贡献，而且他的物理理论代表了超越德谟克利特原子论的理论进步。这一进步部分体现在伊壁鸠鲁物理学避免了作为德谟克利特观点标志的严格机械决定论。在此基础上，马克思认为伊壁鸠鲁提出了一种能够容纳自由的唯物主义世界观。

为了理解马克思对古希腊原子论的研究及其关于自由与决定论之间关系的观点，首先有必要较为详细地介绍德谟克利特和伊壁鸠鲁的物理体系。

德谟克利特认为，物质的基本物理结构由原子组成——即微小、不可分割的粒子——它们沿直线运动。德谟克利特物理学中原子的运动完全由作用于它们的外力决定。它们在外力作用下运动，要么受重力向下拉动的推动，要么受原子间碰撞力的推动。伊壁鸠鲁采纳了德谟克利特原子论的框架，并做出了以下显著修正：原子并非仅沿直线运动，其路径严格由

by external forces acting on the atom. Rather, atoms sometimes, but not always, “swerved” slightly from their original paths. This motion was determined not by the action of external forces, but by the atoms’ own intrinsic natures.

As Walter Englert demonstrates persuasively in *Epicurus on the Swerve and Voluntary Action*, Epicurus developed his doctrine of the swerve as a response to a challenge from Aristotle. How could one explain the motion of animals—a self-movement that resisted explanation in terms of strict mechanistic determinism—using atomistic theory? This challenge left Epicurus with two choices:

either to assert that living creatures only apparently had this power, and that all their motions could be explained in terms of the weight and collisions of atoms from which they are made, or to find a new motion in the atoms that could account for the property in animals.¹⁴

Epicurus chose the latter course. With the addition of the swerve to his atomistic physics, Epicurus posited a type of atomic motion that allowed for atoms to move in ways not determined purely by their weight and collisions. The apparently nondeterministic and voluntary motion of animals could then be explained in virtue of this property of the atoms that comprised them.

This “swerve” distinguishes Epicurus’s physics from Democritus’s. Since the motion of atoms is not completely determined by external forces, Epicurus’s physics describes a world that is not strictly mechanistically deterministic and in which atoms as individual entities are not simply subject to external necessity. For Marx, this is a crucial and fruitful departure from Democritus. Marx sees the swerve as a natural physical explanation for the possibility of individuals to intervene into the material world beyond themselves, through activity determined by their own unique qualities. This allows for the “existence” of an atom to be in harmony with its “essence.” This harmony of existence with essence constitutes the real expression of the atom, the reconciliation of the conflict between freedom and necessity. As Marx writes:

The contradiction between existence and essence, between matter and form, which is inherent in the concept of the atom, emerges in the individual atom itself once it is endowed with qualities. Through the quality the atom is alienated from its concept, but at the same time is perfected in its

作用于原子的外力所决定。相反，原子有时（但并非总是）会从其原始路径上“偏斜”少许。这种运动并非由外力的作用所决定，而是由原子自身的内在本质所决定。

正如沃尔特·恩格尔特在《伊壁鸠鲁论原子的偏斜与自愿行动》中令人信服地指出的那样，伊壁鸠鲁提出其偏文学说，是对亚里士多德提出的挑战所作出的回应。如何运用原子论来解释生物的运动——一种抵抗严格机械决定论解释的自发性运动？这一挑战使伊壁鸠鲁面临两种选择：

要么断言生物仅看似拥有这种能力，其所有运动均可通过构成它们的原子的重量和碰撞来解释；要么在原子的运动中寻找一种新机制，以解释生物所具有的这种属性。¹⁴

伊壁鸠鲁选择了后者。通过在原子物理学中引入偏斜，伊壁鸠鲁假设了一种原子运动类型，使得原子能够以不完全由其重量和碰撞决定的方式运动。由此，生物看似非决定论的、自愿的运动，便可基于构成它们的原子的这一属性得到解释。

这种“偏斜”将伊壁鸠鲁的物理学与德谟克利特的区分开来。由于原子的运动并非完全由外力决定，伊壁鸠鲁的物理学描述了一个并非严格机械决定论的世界，其中作为个体实体的原子并非单纯受制于外在的必然性。对马克思而言，这是与德谟克利特的一个关键且富有成果的背离。马克思将偏斜视为一种自然的物理解释，说明个体如何通过由其自身独特品质所决定的活动，介入到其自身之外的物质世界。这使得原子的“存在”能够与其“本质”相和谐。这种存在与本质的和谐构成了原子的真实表达，即自由与必然之间冲突的调和。正如马克思所写：

存在于本质与存在之间、物质与形式之间的矛盾，内在于原子的概念之中，一旦原子被赋予性质，这种矛盾便在该有质原子自身中显现。通过性质，原子与其概念相异化，但与此同时也在其

construction. It is from repulsion and the ensuing conglomerations of the qualified atoms that the world of appearance now emerges.¹⁵

The swerve allowed the atom to differentiate and distinguish itself in terms of its relationship to other atoms. But atoms as purely abstract objects are incapable of realizing themselves in matter in this way. Only concretely individual atoms with specific qualities can repel other atoms, thereby differentiating themselves and coming to exist in correspondence with their essences. As George McCarthy writes in his very lucid and detailed treatment of Marx on Epicurus:

For the atom to exist and be real, it must have certain spatial qualities such as size, shape, and weight and thus take on a determinate existence. However, as a determinate being with material existence, the atom must take on qualities or properties that contradict its essence as pure immediacy and abstract individuality (alienation). It is this contradiction between material existence and essence (Concept) that lies at the heart of Epicurus's philosophy and his view of Greek society. Marx saw in Epicurus the first philosopher to incorporate the notion of the contradiction between essence and reality into his thought.¹⁶

Abstract unqualified objects cannot exist because they cannot affect matter, and cannot thereby bring about the expression of their essences. It is for this reason that Marx says "abstract individuality is freedom from being, not freedom in being."¹⁷ Moreover, Marx argued, reasoning based on contemplation of such abstract objects will necessarily lapse into methodological idealism. Centering abstractions means eschewing material determinations as *mere* appearances that distract from a proper appreciation of the nature of reality, rather than being the absolute starting place for a proper understanding of it.

The Epicurean swerve was attacked by a number of ancient commentators on the basis that Epicurus provided inadequate philosophical justification for belief in such a property of atoms. Cicero notably complained that Epicurus's doctrine of the swerve was "rather to beg the question than to discuss it."

He argued that Epicurus's theory of the swerve had established

A fortuitous concourse of atoms to help us out of our difficulty. [...] But you have not yet discovered that primitive power in nature from which your

构造中得到完善。正是从排斥以及由此产生的有质原子的聚合中，现象世界得以显现。¹⁵

偏斜使原子能够根据与其他原子的关系进行区分和确立自身。但作为纯粹抽象对象的原子无法以这种方式在物质中实现自身。只有具有特定属性的具体个别原子才能排斥其他原子，从而区分自身并与其本质相对应地存在。正如乔治·麦卡锡在他对马克思论伊壁鸠鲁的非常清晰详尽的论述中所写：

原子若要存在并具有现实性，就必须具备某些空间属性，如大小、形状和重量，从而获得确定的存在。然而，作为具有物质存在的确定存在者，原子必须获得与其作为纯粹直接性和抽象个体性的本质相矛盾的属性或性质（异化）。正是物质存在与本质（概念）之间的这一矛盾，构成了伊壁鸠鲁哲学及其对希腊社会观点的核心。马克思在伊壁鸠鲁身上看到了第一位将本质与现实之间矛盾的概念融入其思想中的哲学家。¹⁶

抽象的无规定性对象无法存在，因为它们无法影响物质，从而无法实现其本质的表达。正因如此，马克思说“抽象个别性是脱离存在的自由，而非存在于其中的自由”。¹⁷ 此外，马克思认为，基于对此类抽象对象的沉思而进行的推理必然陷入方法论唯心主义。以抽象为中心意味着将物质规定性仅仅视为表象，认为它们会分散人们对现实本质的正确理解，而不是将其作为正确理解现实的绝对起点。

伊壁鸠鲁原子偏斜受到多位古代评论家的攻击，理由是伊壁鸠鲁为相信原子具有这种属性提供了不充分的哲学辩护。西塞罗尤其抱怨说，伊壁鸠鲁关于偏斜的学说“与其说是讨论它，不如说是乞题”。

他论证说，伊壁鸠鲁的偏斜理论确立了

原子的偶然汇聚助我们摆脱困境。[。 。 。] 但你尚未发现自然中那种原始力量，你的

atoms derive their motion. [. . .] You have not yet revealed to us any extrinsic cause which impresses each atom with that impulse which gives it its proper direction.¹⁸

Marx argues that this demand for a cause of the swerve is beside the point, since for it to be caused in the way that Cicero demands would be for it to be brought back into the domain of a mechanistic determinism. Marx writes, “To inquire after the cause that makes the atom a principle—a clearly meaningless inquiry to anyone for whom the atom is the cause of everything, hence without cause itself.”¹⁹

Marx's defense of the Epicurean swerve is that on Epicurus's atomistic physics, the atom itself is the active principle in nature. Therefore, the movement of Epicurus's atom is very far from requiring an explanation in terms of the forces exerted upon it by the rest of the natural world. Instead the Epicurean atom itself determines that world. Marx admires in Epicurus's thought its lack of reliance, in contrast to Aristotle's “unmoved mover,” upon an external source of motion in order to explain the existence and appearance of the natural world.

While for our purposes it has been necessary to present a general explanation of the doctrines in Epicurus that Marx chose to treat in his first extended philosophical work, what is crucial to notice in the doctoral dissertation is not so much this or that vagary of Epicurus's physics, and Marx's reaction to each bit of it, but rather Marx's overarching interest in defending what he recognizes as a brand of materialism that can accommodate freedom, conscious activity, and intervention into the material world. As James O'Rourke writes in his 1974 book *The Problem of Freedom in Marxist Thought*, “although Marx himself does not endorse the Epicurean position *en bloc*, it is clear from the text that he is in genuine sympathy with its leading principles, especially those which seem to be compatible with the Hegelian philosophy of spirit.” This gives us some *prima facie* reason for skepticism that Marx himself endorsed a mechanistic determinism that would have far more in common with Democritus, whose physics he already rejects at this early stage in his philosophical development, than it does with Epicurus.

However, Marx is also critical of the role that atoms as abstract individuals continue to play in Epicurus's physics. As George McCarthy writes in *Marx and the Ancients*:

原子正是从这种力量中获得运动。[。 。 。] 你尚未向我们揭示任何外在原因，使每个原子获得那种赋予其正确方向的冲动。¹⁸

马克思认为，这种对偏斜之原因的追问是无关紧要的，因为如果按照西塞罗的要求使其被原因所决定，那就意味着将其重新拉回机械决定论的领域。马克思写道：“追问使原子成为原则的原因——对于任何认为原子是万物之因、因而自身无因的人来说，这显然是一个毫无意义的追问。”¹⁹

马克思为伊壁鸠鲁原子偏斜所作的辩护是：在伊壁鸠鲁的原子物理学中，原子本身就是自然界中的能动原则。因此，伊壁鸠鲁原子的运动远不需要用自然界其余部分对其施加的力来解释。相反，伊壁鸠鲁的原子本身决定了那个世界。马克思赞赏伊壁鸠鲁思想中缺乏对亚里士多德“不动的动者”那样的依赖，即不依赖外部运动来源来解释自然世界的存在与显现。

虽然出于我们的目的，有必要对马克思在其第一部扩展哲学著作中选择的伊壁鸠鲁学说进行一般性解释，但在博士论文中至关重要的并非伊壁鸠鲁物理学的种种奇思妙想及其马克思的逐一反应，而是马克思致力于捍卫一种他认为能够容纳自由、自觉活动以及对物质世界干预的唯物主义。正如詹姆斯·奥鲁克在其1974年出版的《马克思主义思想中的自由问题》一书中所写：“尽管马克思本人并未全盘接受伊壁鸠鲁的立场，但从文本中可以清楚地看出，他对其主要原则怀有真正的同情，尤其是那些似乎与黑格尔精神哲学相容的原则。”这为我们提供了一种初步的理由去怀疑马克思本人是否支持一种机械决定论，这种决定论与其说与伊壁鸠鲁相似，不如说与德谟克利特更为接近，而马克思在其哲学发展的这一早期阶段就已经拒绝了德谟克利特的物理学。

然而，马克思也批判了作为抽象个人的原子在伊壁鸠鲁物理学中继续扮演的角色。正如乔治·麦卡锡在《马克思与古代人》中所写：

The radical individualism of Epicurus was necessary to undermine positivism and religion, but was not adequate to develop a real social anthropology or theory of society based on friendship, citizenship, and public participation. For this, a turn to Feuerbach's notion of species being and Aristotle's view of democracy and citizenship would become necessary.

It would be Marx's immediate task in his early writings to move from one level to the other, to move from abstract self-consciousness and freedom to concrete self-consciousness in the political economy. In order to overcome the contradictions of existence and essence—materialism and ethics—implicit in Epicurean physics, the alienation of the objective and physical world must be overcome through social praxis. The theoretical praxis and ethical critique of the philosopher must be transformed into effective action on the world and a change-over of the institutions of political economy. The *Dissertation* sets the path, the direction, and the priorities for Marx's earliest and later studies on the social relations of production. Just as the *Dissertation* begins with a critique of the foreign externality of nature, *Capital* begins with a critique of the “natural laws” of political economy. It is this relation between self-consciousness and nature in all its material forms—from physics to political economy—that is at the heart and soul of Marx's lifework.²⁰

But before we get to our discussion of *Capital*, let us note that if there were a single text to which one might look for support in reading Marx as a strict determinist, it would likely be the *Communist Manifesto*. It is Marx's great rallying cry, in which he famously exhorts workers to revolution with assurances that they've “a world to win” and “only their chains to lose.” However, on closer inspection we find that even in the *Manifesto*, Marx sees history trending in a direction that produces the increasingly greater possibility of communism—but not its inevitability.

In the *Manifesto*, Marx writes that “What the bourgeoisie . . . produces, above all, is its own grave-diggers. Its fall and the victory of the proletariat are equally inevitable.”²¹ This claim locates both the strength and the Achilles's heel of the bourgeoisie in one and the same historical force: the working class. Capitalists accumulate wealth by extracting surplus value from the human beings who are compelled to sell their ability to labor. At the same time that this relationship enriches and empowers the capitalist class, it also sows the seeds of what may become its eventual destruction. Marx makes this point in

伊壁鸠鲁的激进个人主义对于颠覆实证主义和宗教是必要的，但不足以发展出基于友谊、公民身份和公共参与的真实社会人类学或社会理论。为此，转向费尔巴哈的类存在概念以及亚里士多德关于民主和公民身份的观点将是必要的。

在早期著作中，马克思的当务之急是从一个层次转向另一个层次，即从抽象的自我意识和自由转向政治经济学中的具体自我意识。为了克服伊壁鸠鲁物理学中隐含的存在与本质、唯物主义与伦理学之间的矛盾，必须通过社会实践克服客观物质世界的异化。哲学家的理论实践和伦理批判必须转化为对世界的有效行动，以及对政治经济学制度的变革。博士论文为马克思最早及后来的生产关系研究指明了路径、方向和优先事项。正如博士论文始于对自然外在性的批判，资本论也始于对政治经济学“自然规律”的批判。正是自我意识与一切物质形态的自然（从物理学到政治经济学）之间的关系，构成了马克思毕生工作的核心与灵魂。²⁰

但在我们开始讨论《资本论》之前，让我们注意到，如果有一部单一文本可供人们将马克思视为严格决定论者的依据，那很可能是《共产党宣言》。这是马克思伟大的战斗口号，他在那里著名地号召工人进行革命，并保证他们“有一个世界要赢得”且“只有锁链要失去”。然而，经过更仔细的考察，我们发现即使在《宣言》中，马克思也认为历史呈现出一种趋势，即产生共产主义日益增长的可能性——但并非其必然性。

在《宣言》中，马克思写道：“资产阶级.....生产的，首先是它自身的掘墓人。它的灭亡和无产阶级的胜利是同样不可避免的。”²¹ 这一论断将资产阶级的力量和阿喀琉斯之踵都置于同一个历史力量之中：工人阶级。资本家通过从被迫出卖劳动能力的人类身上榨取剩余价值来积累财富。与此同时，这种关系在使资产阶级阶级富裕并赋予其权力的同时，也播下了可能导致其最终毁灭的种子。马克思在”

his criticism of feudal opposition to the bourgeoisie, writing, "What they upbraid the bourgeoisie with is not so much that it creates a proletariat as that it creates a revolutionary proletariat."²²

Marx's claim that the bourgeoisie's fall and the proletariat's victory are "equally inevitable" ought to be understood in this context. They are "equally inevitable" because their sources are the same. Because the conditions of the bourgeoisie are mirrored in those of the working class, each is precisely as likely as the other. This is not to say that the proletariat's victory is inevitable, full stop, but rather to stress that the emergence and development of the proletariat, a necessary condition of the capitalist mode of production, is inextricably linked to the capitalist enterprise itself.

Marx speaks, especially in *Capital*, of the capitalist as "capital personified and endowed with consciousness and a will."²³ A capitalist is a person who acts in a manner that is to a great extent determined by economic laws that guide the movement of the capital she possesses. Marx also speaks, in *Capital* and elsewhere, of the actions of the proletariat understood in terms of what it is as a class and what, by virtue of that nature, it will be compelled to do.

As we discussed at the beginning of this chapter, numerous authors have taken this strand in Marx's thought to imply a crude economic determinism. Marx is (mis)characterized as professing human actions to be one-sidedly determined by economic laws that operate beyond their control. But what Marx describes when he addresses the way in which economic laws play a role in determining the actions of human beings, are tendencies of members of various social groups to act in circumstances shaped through those laws. These are not iron-clad predictions for particular individuals. Howard Sherman, in his 1981 paper "Marx and Determinism," puts this point very well:

Marx pointed out that one can find regularities of human behavior, that on the average we do behave in certain predictable ways. This behavior also changes in systematic ways, with predictable trends, in association with changes in our technological and social environments. At a simpler level, the regularities of human behavior are obvious in the fairly constant annual numbers of suicides and divorces (although these also show systematic trends). If humans did not, generally, behave in fairly predictable ways, not only social scientists but also insurance companies would have gone out of business long ago. Any particular individual may make any particular choice, but if we know the social composition of a group, we can predict,

他对资产阶级反对封建反对的批评中指出：“他们指责资产阶级的地方，不在于它产生了无产阶级，而在于它产生了革命无产阶级。”²²

马克思关于资产阶级的衰落和无产阶级的胜利“同样不可避免”的主张，应当在此背景下理解。它们之所以“同样不可避免”，是因为它们的根源相同。由于资产阶级的条件在工人阶级中得到映照，二者各自发生的可能性完全相同。这并不是说无产阶级的胜利是绝对不可避免的，而是强调作为资本主义生产方式必要条件的无产阶级的出现与发展，与资本主义企业本身密不可分。

马克思在《资本论》及其他著作中曾将资本家描述为“人格化了的资本，并拥有意识和意志”。²³ 资本家是一种在很大程度上受其拥有的资本所遵循的经济规律所支配行动的人。马克思在《资本论》及其他著作中也论述了无产阶级的行动，将其理解为基于其作为阶级的本质以及由此本质所必然 **compelled** 采取的行动。

正如我们在本章开头所讨论的那样，许多作者将马克思思想中的这一脉络理解为一种粗浅的经济决定论。马克思被（错误地）描述为主张人类行动单方面地由超出其控制范围的经济规律所决定。然而，当马克思论述经济规律在决定人类行动中的作用时，他所描述的实际上是各种社会群体的成员在通过这些规律塑造的环境中行动的倾向。这些并非针对特定个人的铁律预测。霍华德·谢尔曼在其1981年的论文《马克思与决定论》中对此观点阐述得非常到位：

马克思指出，人们可以找到人类行为的规律，即从平均意义上讲，我们确实以某些可预测的方式行事。这种行为也会随着技术和社交环境的变化，以系统的方式和可预测的趋势发生演变。在较简单的层面上，人类行为的规律性在相对恒定的年度自杀和离婚数量中显而易见（尽管这些也显示出系统性趋势）。如果人类通常不以相对可预测的方式行事，那么不仅社会科学家，就连保险公司也早已破产。任何特定的个人都可能做出任何特定的选择，但如果我们了解一个群体的社会构成，我们就可以预测，

in general, what it will do. Thus, on the average, most large owners of stock will vote in favor of preferential tax rates for capital gains; most farmers will favor laws that they believe to be in the interest of farmers.²⁴

As a rule, a capitalist will tend to maximize his profit irrespective of the social repercussions. A bourgeois intellectual will tend to develop theoretical justifications for the continuation of capitalism, often in spite of the glaring social contradictions. Within a bourgeois standpoint, and even while continuing to support the bourgeoisie as the class most suited to lead humanity economically, politically, and socially, it is possible for certain members of this class to develop a keen understanding of the social contradictions produced by class society. In some cases, bourgeois ideologists develop real commitments to such noble and crucial aims as human development or the eradication of ills such as global poverty and ecological destruction. Marx recognizes this phenomenon as a feature of the subjective consciousness of individual bourgeois theorists. For instance, in *Capital*, Marx notes that the capitalist “Robert Owen, soon after 1810, not only maintained the necessity of a limitation of the working-day in theory, but actually introduced the 10 hours’ day into his factory at New Lanark,” even though “this was laughed at as a communistic Utopia.”²⁵

Marx goes on to credit Owen with developing an approach to education that could serve as an early model for education in a communist society:

From the Factory system budded, as Robert Owen has shown us in detail, the germ of the education of the future, an education that will, in the case of every child over a given age, combine productive labour with instruction and gymnastics, not only as one of the methods of adding to the efficiency of production, but as the only method of producing fully developed human beings.

According to Marx, the progressive aspects of Owen’s thought were, in the end, limited by his failure to recognize the proletariat as the class best suited to lead humanity out of the contradictions produced by class society. For Marx, a bourgeois class position and standpoint tend to delimit the range of actions and opinions we are likely to see even from a reformer such as Owen. However, it would be wrong to ignore that within that position and perspective there remains a wide array of open choices for individual actors and they may formulate valuable insights and opinions, and that these views

从总体上看，该群体会做什么。因此，从平均意义上讲，大多数股票持有者将投票支持有利于资本利得的优惠税率；大多数农民将支持他们认为是符合农民利益的法律。²⁴

通常，资本家倾向于不顾社会后果而最大化其利润。资产阶级知识分子倾向于为资本主义的延续提供理论辩护，往往无视明显的社会矛盾。在资产阶级立场上，甚至在继续支持资产阶级作为在经济、政治和社会方面最适合领导人类的阶级的同时，该阶级的某些成员仍可能对阶级社会所产生的社会矛盾形成深刻的理解。在某些情况下，资产阶级意识形态家会对人类发展或消除全球贫困和生态破坏等崇高而关键的宗旨产生真正的承诺。马克思将这一现象视为个别资产阶级理论家主观意识的特征。例如，在《资本论》中，马克思指出，资本家“罗伯特·欧文，在1810年之后不久，不仅在理论上坚持限制工作日的必要性，而且实际上在他的新拉纳克工厂引入了10小时工作制”，尽管“这被嘲笑为共产主义乌托邦”。²⁵

马克思接着称赞欧文发展了一种教育方法，可作为共产主义社会教育的早期模型：

正如罗伯特·欧文向我们详细展示的，从工厂制度中萌芽了未来教育的雏形，这种教育对于超过一定年龄的每个儿童，都将生产劳动与教学、体操结合起来，这不仅是提高生产效率的方法之一，而且是造就全面发展的人类的唯一方法。

根据马克思的观点，欧文思想的进步方面最终受限于其未能认识到无产阶级是领导人类摆脱阶级社会所产生的矛盾的最佳阶级。对马克思而言，资产阶级的阶级立场和观点往往会限制我们所能看到的行动和意见的范围，即便对于像欧文这样的改革者也是如此。然而，忽视在这一立场和视角下，个人行动者仍拥有广泛的选择空间，并可能形成有价值的见解和观点，这是错误的；这些观点

might strive to faithfully reflect reality and even to progressively transform it, pointing beyond that bourgeois perspective.

Another example of this can be found in the work of nineteenth-century French novelist and playwright Honoré de Balzac. Balzac of course had not bourgeois, but actually royalist sympathies, and was opposed to the bourgeoisie at a time when it played a historically progressive role. Yet he was one of Marx's favorite authors, an artist whom Marx describes in *Capital* as "generally remarkable for his profound grasp of reality."²⁶

In an 1888 letter, Engels further elucidates the genius of Balzac's realism. Engels writes the letter in response to a request that he review a novel written by a socialist author. He concludes that the novel is not very good, criticizing it particularly for being unrealistic in its depiction of the working class as a passive mass. Engels goes on to illustrate his point with a discussion of the realism to be found in Balzac's work, a realism that is achieved in spite of the latter's royalist sympathies:

Balzac was politically a Legitimist; his great work is a constant elegy on the inevitable decay of good society, his sympathies are all with the class doomed to extinction. But for all that his satire is never keener, his irony never bitterer, than when he sets in motion the very men and women with whom he sympathizes most deeply—the nobles. And the only men of whom he always speaks with undisguised admiration, are his bitterest political antagonists, the republican heroes of the Cloître Saint-Méry, the men, who at that time (1830–6) were indeed the representatives of the popular masses. That Balzac thus was compelled to go against his own class sympathies and political prejudices, that he saw the necessity of the downfall of his favourite nobles, and described them as people deserving no better fate; and that he saw the real men of the future where, for the time being, they alone were to be found—that I consider one of the greatest triumphs of Realism, and one of the grandest features in old Balzac.²⁷

A figure such as Robert Owen demonstrates some of the most progressive viewpoints possible within a bourgeois perspective. More typically, there are persons such as John D. Rockefeller or John F. Kennedy, who simply seek mostly to rationally advance the interests of their class. (I am speaking of a narrowly instrumental "rationality" in these cases.) Additionally, there are individuals such as Joseph McCarthy who actively promote the most brazenly reactionary tendencies of their class.

可能致力于忠实地反映现实，甚至逐步地改造它，从而超越资产阶级的视角。

这一点的另一个例子可以在十九世纪法国小说家和剧作家奥诺雷·德·巴尔扎克的作品中找到。巴尔扎克当然没有资产阶级的立场，反而具有保皇派同情，并且在他所反对的资产阶级尚处于历史进步角色时就反对它。然而，他是马克思最喜爱的作家之一，马克思在《资本论》中将其描述为“总体上因其对现实的深刻把握而著称”。²⁶

在1888年的一封信中，恩格斯进一步阐明了巴尔扎克现实主义的天才之处。恩格斯写这封信是为了回应一项请求，即让他评论一位社会主义作家所写的一部小说。他得出结论，认为这部小说并不太好，特别批评其将工人阶级描绘为被动群体的做法缺乏现实性。恩格斯随后通过讨论巴尔扎克作品中所体现的现实主义来阐明他的观点，这种现实主义是尽管巴尔扎克具有保皇派同情而依然实现的：

巴尔扎克在政治上属于正统派；他的伟大作品是一首对良好社会必然衰落的永恒挽歌，他的同情心完全倾注于注定要消亡的阶级。然而，无论何时，当他让那些他最深切同情的男人和女人——即贵族——行动起来时，他的讽刺从未如此尖锐，他的反语从未如此辛辣。而他始终毫不掩饰地赞赏的，只有他最激烈的政治对手，即圣梅里修道院的共和派英雄们，那些人当时（1830–1836）确实是群众力量的代表。我认为，巴尔扎克因此不得不违背自己的阶级同情和政治偏见，认识到他心爱的贵族必然走向灭亡，并将他们描述为应得此种命运的人；同时，他看到了未来真正的力量所在，尽管当时那里只有他们——这是现实主义最伟大的胜利之一，也是老巴尔扎克最宏伟的特征之一。²⁷

像罗伯特·欧文这样的人物展现了在资产阶级视角内可能存在的某些最进步的见解。更典型的情况是，存在像约翰·D·洛克菲勒或约翰·F·肯尼迪这样的人物，他们仅仅寻求理性地推进其阶级的利益。

（在这些情况下，我指的是狭隘的工具性“理性”。）此外，还有像约瑟夫·麦卡锡这样的人物，他们积极推崇其阶级中最厚颜无耻的反动倾向。

In the face of this evident diversity in ruling class thought, Marx would argue that across this range of bourgeois actors, their identifications with that class inhibit them, from fully recognizing the progressive role of the proletariat and its fitness to lead society. So long as they maintain their bourgeois identification, they are unlikely to fully embrace the historical materialist perspective developed in Marx's thought. However, within that bourgeois perspective and bourgeois class identification, a wide range of thought and action is possible. The charge of crude economic determinism does not fully allow for this, as Marx does.

Furthermore, not only is a wide range of thought and action possible within a bourgeois class identification, but it is possible for individuals to choose to renounce that identification entirely. Already in *The Communist Manifesto*, Marx explains that confronted by the immense contradictions of capitalist society, an increasing number of individual members of the bourgeoisie (and of the petty bourgeoisie) may switch their class allegiance entirely to the camp of the proletariat. These virtuous turncoats come to the view that it is only the victory of the working class, leading a movement toward communism, that can safeguard the continued existence and development of humanity. Of course, one need look no further than Marx's collaborator, Engels, for an example of a bourgeois who chose this course. However, it would be deeply misguided to develop a theory of, and a program for, social and economic development that relied heavily on such occasional changes of camp. In a society based on profit, it is the profit motive, by and large, that dominates in the decision-making of capitalists, just as it is the conscious or unconscious struggle against the inhuman aspects of labor under capitalism that dominates in the decision-making of workers.

Marx argues that economic relations determine human action to a significant extent, but this by no means licenses interpreters to dub him a strict economic determinist who sees no room for freedom of human action. Marx is able to describe and account for a wide range of human action, even as he sees that action being constrained by economic factors. Marx's theory, as a theory of the emancipation of the human species through the self-emancipation of the working class, depends precisely on the struggle of human beings to realize themselves as free and conscious human actors, and further, to be more than "appendages to machines" or mere subjects of economic and social relations that dominate them instead of being directed by them.

In *Capital*, Marx discusses the economic trends that prepare the way for a fully human existence, but critics who accuse Marx of seeing communism

面对统治阶级思想中这种明显的多样性，马克思会认为，在这一系列的资产阶级行动者中，他们对该阶级的认同阻碍了他们充分认识到无产阶级的进步作用及其领导社会的能力。只要他们保持资产阶级认同，他们就不太可能完全接受马克思思想中发展的历史唯物主义视角。然而，在资产阶级视角和资产阶级阶级认同之内，思想和行动的范围是广泛的。粗糙的经济决定论的指控并不像马克思那样能充分容纳这一点。

此外，在资产阶级身份认同的范围内，不仅存在广泛的思想 and 行动可能性，而且个人甚至可以选择完全放弃这种身份认同。正如马克思在《共产党宣言》中所阐述的那样，面对资本主义社会中巨大的矛盾，越来越多的资产阶级（以及小资产阶级）成员可能会完全改变其阶级归属，转而加入无产阶级阵营。这些具有高尚品格的“叛变者”认为，只有工人阶级取得胜利并领导走向共产主义的运动，才能保障人类的持续存在与发展。当然，我们无需远求，马克思的合作伙伴恩格斯就是这样一个选择这条道路的资产阶级分子。然而，若构建一种社会与经济发展理论和纲领，并过度依赖此类偶然的阵营转换，那将是严重的误导。在基于利润的社会中，大体上支配资本家决策的是利润动机；同样，支配工人决策的是有意识或无意识地反抗资本主义下劳动的非人化方面。

马克思认为经济关系在很大程度上决定了人类的行为，但这绝不允许解释者称他为严格的经济决定论者，认为人类行为毫无自由空间。马克思能够描述并解释广泛的人类行为，即使他看到这些行为受到经济因素的制约。马克思的理论作为通过工人阶级自我解放实现人类物种解放的理论，恰恰依赖于人类为将自己实现为自由且自觉的人类行动者而进行的斗争，更进一步，是要超越成为“机器的附属品”或仅仅是被支配而非指导他们的经济和社会关系的主体。

在《资本论》中，马克思讨论了为一种完全的人类存在铺平道路的经济趋势，但指责马克思将共产主义视为决定论者必然性的批评家未能认识到，他也讨论了资本主义如何阻碍人类进步。

as a matter of deterministic historical inevitability fail to appreciate that he also discusses how capitalism inhibits human progress. Left unchecked, capitalism would render progress ultimately impossible. In the first volume of *Capital*, Marx writes:

Capital that has such good reasons for denying the sufferings of the legions of workers that surround it, is in practice moved as much and as little by the sight of the coming degradation and final depopulation of the human race, as by the probable fall of the earth into the sun. In every stockjobbing swindle every one knows that some time or other the crash must come, but every one hopes that it may fall on the head of his neighbour, after he himself has caught the shower of gold and placed it in safety. *Après moi le déluge!* [After me, the flood] is the watchword of every capitalist and of every capitalist nation. Hence Capital is reckless of the health or length of life of the labourer, unless under compulsion from society. To the out-cry as to the physical and mental degradation, the premature death, the torture of overwork, it answers: Ought these to trouble us since they increase our profits? But looking at things as a whole, all this does not, indeed, depend on the good or ill will of the individual capitalist. Free competition brings out the inherent laws of capitalist production, in the shape of external coercive laws having power over every individual capitalist.²⁸

Several important themes are expressed in this passage. First, far from leading inexorably toward a communist future, capital—and of course, the capitalist class, taken as a whole—looks impassively at the “coming degradation and final depopulation of the human race.” This prospect is treated as though it were merely some regrettable but ultimately unalterable natural certainty. (Relating this to the contemporary situation, we can consider the baleful shoulder-shrugging that typifies the attitudes of many of today’s world governments toward impending and already unfolding catastrophes such as global climate change.)

It is only under “compulsion from society” that humanity can be taken off of its collision course with the destructive effects of capitalism. The conscious and active intervention of the masses into politics and into world history is ultimately all that stands between us and this “final depopulation.” We can see that Marx agreed with this from his own political engagement with the workers’ movement, not to mention his lifelong dedication to investigating how the social and economic gains of capitalism can be preserved and

若不加限制，资本主义将使进步最终成为不可能。在《资本论》第一卷中，马克思写道：

《资本论》有如此充分的理由否认其周围千百万工人所遭受的苦难，实际上，它对人类种族即将到来的退化和最终人口减少的漠视程度，与对地球最终坠入太阳的漠视程度毫无二致。在每一次股票投机骗局中，每个人都清楚迟早会发生崩溃，但每个人都希望崩溃降临在邻人的头上，而自己在攫取了一阵雨般的黄金并将其安全藏匿之后。‘死后洪水滔天！[After me, the flood]’是每一个资本家以及每一个资本主义国家的座右铭。因此，除非受到来自社会的强制，资本对劳动者的健康或寿命毫不在意。面对关于身体和精神堕落、过早死亡、过度劳动折磨的控诉，它的回答是：既然这些增加了我们的利润，我们何必为此烦恼？但纵观全局，这一切确实并不取决于个别资本家的善意或恶意。自由竞争揭示了资本主义生产的内在规律，其表现形式为对每一个个别资本家都具有约束力的外在强制法律。

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这段文字表达了几个重要主题。首先，资本——当然，作为整体的资产阶级——并非必然导向共产主义未来，而是冷漠地注视着“人类即将到来的退化及最终的人口减少”。这一前景被当作某种虽令人遗憾但最终不可改变的天然必然性来处理。（将这一点与当代局势联系起来，我们可以考虑当今许多世界各国政府面对迫在眉睫且正在展开的灾难，如全球气候变化时，那种典型的幸灾乐祸的耸肩态度。）

只有在“来自社会的强制”下，人类才能摆脱与资本主义破坏性影响的碰撞轨道。群众对政治和世界历史的自觉而积极的干预，最终是我们与这场“最终人口减少”之间唯一的屏障。我们可以从马克思自身对工人运动的政治参与中看出他对此的认同，更不用说他对探究如何保存和

subsumed in a higher stage of social development, and his conviction that just this ought to be done and could only be done by the active masses. Marx prioritized the majority of society acting in the interest of the majority of society.

Second, we see mentioned in this passage the way in which the “free competition” of capitalist society reveals itself to be unfreedom in practice, taking on the “shape of external coercive laws having power over every individual capitalist.” One important question to be asked of those who see here some ground to label Marx a crude economic determinist and therefore an amoralist, is whether they can really doubt that capitalists generally act in ways designed to preserve and multiply their capital. “Looking at things as a whole,” the capitalist, no matter how noble he might be in his heart of hearts, whether his will be “good or ill,” must extract as much labor as possible, at as little cost to himself as possible. This remains true if he wishes to compete in the marketplace and to remain a capitalist, at all. It is this general tendency of people in capitalist society to defend their economic interests that makes it possible to predict that class struggle between the bourgeoisie and the proletariat, whose interests are in conflict with one another, will take place. However, it does not by any means guarantee which side will win out in that inevitable conflict.

It is true that there are numerous occasions on which Marx expresses his conviction that human beings would achieve a communist society. I happen to think this view was reasonable, based on the historical vantage point available to Marx at the time. However, as Sherman writes in his 1981 paper “Marx and Determinism”:

Human beings are free to make (or not make) a revolution, but our actions are predictable by a knowledge of present and previous conditions, including our psychologies, and the laws or regularities of human behavior under these conditions. “To say that the revolution is inevitable is simply (in Marx’s scheme) to say that it will occur. And it will occur . . . not in spite of any choices we might make, but because of choices we will make.”²⁹ The prediction of socialist revolution, however, must be expressed as a probability rather than a certainty because of our limited knowledge of the conditions and the laws.

Under capitalism, the range of actions available to people are narrowed. And within that narrow range, people are most likely, “as a whole,” to take the

将其纳入社会发展的更高阶段以被吸纳的毕生奉献，以及他坚信这应当被完成且只能由积极大众来完成。马克思优先考虑的是社会的大多数为社会的绝大多数利益而行动。

其次，我们在该段落中看到，资本主义社会的“自由竞争”在实践中如何显露为不自由，呈现出“外在的强制法律对每个资本家拥有权力”的“形状”。一个需要向那些在此找到依据将马克思贴上粗俗经济决定论者因此是非道德主义者标签的人提出的问题，是他们是否真的会怀疑资本家通常采取旨在保存和增殖其资本的行动。“纵观全局”，资本家无论其内心多么高尚，无论其意志是“善”还是“恶”，都必须尽可能多地榨取劳动，同时尽可能降低自身的成本。如果他希望在市场上竞争并继续做一名资本家，这一点始终成立。正是资本主义社会中人们捍卫其经济利益这一普遍倾向，使得我们可以预测，利益相互冲突的资产阶级与无产阶级之间的阶级斗争将会发生。然而，这丝毫不能保证在那场不可避免的冲突中哪一方会获胜。

确实，马克思在许多场合都表达了他坚信人类将实现共产主义社会的观点。我恰好认为，基于马克思当时所能掌握的历史视角，这一观点是合理的。然而，正如谢尔曼在其1981年的论文《马克思与决定论》中所写：

人类有自由去进行（或不进行）革命，但我们的行为可以通过了解当前及过去的条件（包括我们的心理状态）以及在这些条件下人类行为的规律或法则来预测。“说革命是不可避免的，在马克思的体系中，仅仅是说它将会发生。它确实会发生……并非无视我们可能做出的任何选择，而是因为我们将会做出的选择。”²⁹ 然而，由于我们对条件和法则的了解有限，对社会主义革命的预测必须以概率而非确定性的形式来表达。

在资本主义下，人们可采取的行动范围受到限制。而在这一狭窄范围内，人们最有可能“作为一个整体”去采取

actions that defend their economic interests. Here we might cite again Marx's observation in *The Eighteenth Brumaire of Louis Bonaparte*: "Men make their own history, but they do not make it just as they please; they do not make it under circumstances chosen by themselves, but under circumstances directly found, given and transmitted from the past."³⁰ It is not possible to have a correct understanding of capitalist society without understanding the extent to which many factors, including economic laws, do delimit the range of actions available to people under capitalism, and do make some actions more likely to be taken than some other ones.

Though it is certain that under capitalism, workers will struggle against their conditions, it is by no means simply necessary or historically determined that their struggles will be victorious, or that communism will be achieved. It is not necessary that workers will recognize their class interests, will gain a theoretical understanding of the nature of capitalism, will organize themselves politically in such a way as to effectively promote their interests, or will recognize human development and "rich individuality" as the highest aim for human beings. Even if they achieve all these things, I would like to emphasize that from our historical vantage point today, it is plain to see that that they may not do so before the spoliation of the Earth under the capitalist mode of production is too far gone. We may not avert a premature "final depopulation" of the human race. Whether any of these things do take place, and in a timely way, depends in great part upon the actions of what Marx refers to as the most conscious elements of society setting a political direction and theoretical context for the struggles that emerge. And when they do so, they do so not merely as patients subject to inexorable economic laws, but as historical agents who through their activity, assist their fellows in realizing their historical agency as well. Marx recognizes that there is a space for free and conscious intervention even under capitalism. But he also recognizes that this scope is limited. One of the goals of a communist movement, then, is to intervene consciously into human history in the ways that are currently possible. While constrained by capitalism, the communist movement works to expand the sphere of free action and push necessity back to its furthest possible limit.

None of this is to negate the extent to which economic processes in class society, which are the result of human actions but which have developed spontaneously, without conscious human planning or direction, have led to a historical moment that points toward communism, and provides the material basis for communism. This is how alienated labor can function, over

维护其经济利益的行动。在此我们可再次引用马克思在《路易·波拿巴的雾月十八日》中的论断：“人们自己创造自己的历史，但是他们并不是随心所欲地创造，并不是在他们自己选定的条件下创造，而是在直接碰到的、既定的、从过去承继下来的条件下创造。”³⁰ 若不理解包括经济规律在内的诸多因素在何种程度上限制了资本主义下人们可采取的行动范围，并使某些行动比另一些行动更有可能发生，就不可能对资本主义社会有正确的认识。

虽然可以肯定的是，在资本主义下，工人将为其生存条件而斗争，但这绝非必然或历史地决定了他们的斗争会取得胜利，或共产主义将会实现。工人未必会认识到自身的阶级利益，未必会获得对资本主义本质的理论理解，未必会以有效促进其利益的方式在政治上组织起来，也未必会将人类发展和“丰富的个性”视为人类的最高目标。即使他们实现了所有这些目标，我想强调的是，从我们当今的历史视角来看，显而易见的是，在资本主义生产方式对地球的掠夺变得不可挽回之前，他们未必能做到这一点。我们或许无法避免人类种族过早的“最终人口减少”。这些事情是否会发生，以及是否及时发生，在很大程度上取决于马克思所称的社会中有意识的阶层所采取的行动，即为新兴的斗争设定政治方向和理论背景。当他们这样做时，他们不仅仅是受不可抗拒的经济规律支配的被动者，而是作为历史主体，通过其活动协助同伴实现其历史能动性。马克思认识到，即使在资本主义下，也存在自由而有意识干预的空间。但他也认识到，这一空间是有限的。因此，共产主义运动的目标之一，就是以当前可能的方式有意识地干预人类历史。在受资本主义制约的同时，共产主义运动致力于扩大自由行动的范围，并将必然性推至其可能的极限。

这一切并非要否定阶级社会中经济过程的程度，这些经济过程是人类行动的结果，却自发地发展，没有经过有意识的人类规划或指导，它们已导致了一个指向共产主义的历史时刻，并为共产主义提供了物质基础。这就是异化劳动如何能够在历史进程中发挥作用，使其自身的废除成为可能，并为人类解放创造条件。

the course of history, to make its own abolition more possible, and create the conditions for human emancipation. For instance, as Marx points out, the forces of production are increasingly socialized even if the *relations* of production are not. It is for this reason that Marx could write in *The German Ideology* that “Communism is for us not a *state of affairs* which is to be established, an *ideal* to which reality [will] have to adjust itself. We call communism the *real* movement which abolishes the present state of things. The conditions of this movement result from the now existing premise.”³¹

The whole development of human history is a movement toward a point at which the stakes for humanity become increasingly clear: “given and transmitted from the past,” they boil down to a stark choice. This is the choice either to build a movement that preserves and develops the positive contributions of class society as the historical and material basis on which to create a society that satisfies human needs, or to allow the destructive aspects of capitalism to simply play themselves out, stamping out of existence countless achievements of human culture. Think here, for instance, of fascism and its historical appearance where capitalism has fallen into decay and the workers’ movement has not been able to seize power. In this instance matters would be still more dire: unchecked climate change would quite likely bring about a hastened extinction as a result of ecological crisis.

Because of how capitalism has revolutionized production, it is possible for human beings to devote a vanishingly small amount of time to satisfying their biological needs. They can devote the majority of their lives instead to the intellectual, cultural, and artistic pursuits that enrich the social existence of humanity. These pursuits develop humanity’s existence well beyond the merely biological. To use Marx’s terminology, it is possible for human beings to free themselves in great part from the narrow requirements of “natural necessity.” The capitalist mode of production is especially contradictory in this respect. Through the drive of capitalists to revolutionize the forces of production in order to relentlessly increase efficiency and profits, it has become possible to produce enough to satisfy a wide and expanding array of human needs, and with a minimum of human labor devoted to the satisfaction of subsistence needs. Under class society, however, the economic basis of society places great limits on that human development. As Marx writes in the first book of *Capital*:

All methods for raising the social productiveness of labour are brought about at the cost of the individual labourer; all means for the development

例如，正如马克思所指出的，即使生产关系尚未社会化，生产力却日益社会化。正因如此，马克思才在《德意志意识形态》中写道：“对我们来说，共产主义不是一种应当确立的状况，也不是现实应当与之相适应的理想。我们将共产主义称为消灭现存状况的现实运动。这种运动的产生条件源于现有的前提。”³¹

人类历史的整个发展是一个朝向某个点的运动，在这个点上，人类面临的利害关系变得日益清晰：“从过去继承而来”，它们归结为一个 **stark** 的选择。这个选择要么是建立一个运动，以阶级社会的历史和物质基础为根基，保留并发展其积极贡献，从而创建一个满足人类需求的社会；要么是任由资本主义的破坏性方面自行发展，抹杀人类文化的无数成就。试想一下法西斯主义及其在资本主义陷入腐朽、工人运动未能夺取政权时的历史表现。在这种情况下，事态将更加严峻：不受控制的气候变化很可能因生态危机而加速导致人类的灭绝。

由于资本主义彻底改变了生产方式，人类有可能将极少的时间用于满足其生物需求。他们可以将生命的绝大部分投入到丰富人类社会存在的智力、文化和艺术追求中。这些追求使人类的存在远远超越了单纯的生物层面。用马克思的术语来说，人类有可能在很大程度上从“自然必然性”的狭隘要求中解放出来。资本主义生产方式在这方面尤其具有矛盾性。在资本家推动革命化生产力以 **relentless** 提高效率并增加利润的驱动下，现在已有可能生产出足以满足广泛且不断扩展的人类需求的产品，同时只需极少的劳动时间用于满足生存需求。然而，在阶级社会中，社会的经济基础对这种人类发展施加了巨大限制。正如马克思在《资本论》第一卷中所写：

所有提高劳动的社会生产力的方法，都是以对个体劳动者的牺牲为代价实现的；所有发展生产的手段

of production transform themselves into means of domination over, and exploitation of, the producers; they mutilate the labourer into a fragment of a man, degrade him to the level of an appendage of a machine, destroy every remnant of charm in his work and turn it into a hated toil; they estrange from him the intellectual potentialities of the labour process in the same proportion as science is incorporated in it as an independent power; they distort the conditions under which he works, subject him during the labour process to a despotism the more hateful for its meanness; they transform his life-time into working-time, and drag his wife and child beneath the wheels of the Juggernaut of capital. . . . It establishes an accumulation of misery, corresponding with accumulation of capital. Accumulation of wealth at one pole is, therefore, at the same time accumulation of misery, agony of toil slavery, ignorance, brutality, mental degradation, at the opposite pole, i.e., on the side of the class that produces its own product in the form of capital.³²

At the heart of capitalist production lies a contradiction between the immense wealth produced by this economic system and the immense privation and subjection also produced by it. This passage above puts forward the moral critique of capitalism which Marx levels against capitalism throughout his work. Capitalism produces all manner of human degradation, reducing the human being to the mere “appendage of a machine” and grinding down their intellectual and fully human potential. But at the same time that capitalism degrades the human being, it is also capitalism that produces the material basis for the “rich individuality” which forms the basis of Marx’s moral outlook.

Marx’s moral outlook and his approach to understanding human individuality are based in the historical materialist method that he first outlined in *The German Ideology*, but already employed well before that. The *Grundrisse* opens with the line, “To begin with, the subject to be discussed is *material production*.”³³ How humans produce in the natural world in order to satisfy their needs is the basis for any scientific understanding of human beings. Marx goes on to write that socially determined production of individuals is the starting point for inquiry. Marx’s conception of the individual, which plays a significant role throughout his work, takes on a more robust and concrete character in his later writings. This begins especially with the *Grundrisse*, as a result of the fact that here Marx brings the results of anthropology to bear

都转化为对生产者的统治和剥削手段；它们把劳动者 mutilate 成人的碎片，将其贬低为机器的附属品，摧毁其工作中的一切魅力，将其变为令人憎恶的劳苦；随着科学作为独立力量被纳入劳动过程，它们使劳动者与劳动过程的智力潜能相疏离；它们扭曲其工作条件，在劳动过程中使其服从于一种因其卑鄙而更令人憎恶的专制；它们将其生命时间转化为工作时间，并将其妻子和孩子拖入资本巨兽的轮下。……它确立了与资本积累相对应的贫困积累。因此，一极的财富积累，同时就是另一极，即在生产其自身产品为资本形式的阶级一极的贫困积累、劳苦折磨、奴隶制、愚昧、野蛮、精神堕落的积累。³²

资本主义生产的核心在于，这一经济体系在创造巨大财富的同时，也制造了巨大的贫困与从属。上述段落提出了马克思在其全部著作中对资本主义所进行的道德批判。资本主义导致各种形式的人的异化，将人贬低为仅仅是“机器的附属品”，并扼杀其智力潜能和完全的人性。然而，在资本主义贬低人的同时，正是资本主义为“丰富的个性”奠定了物质基础，而这一基础构成了马克思道德观的核心。

马克思的道德观及其理解人类个体性的方法，基于他在《德意志意识形态》中首次阐述但在此前早已运用的历史唯物主义方法。

《政治经济学批判大纲》开篇即言：“首先，要讨论的课题是物质生产。”³³ 人类如何在自然界中进行生产以满足自身需求，是任何关于人类的科学理解的基础。马克思接着指出，社会决定的个人生产是研究的起点。马克思关于个人的概念在其整个著作中发挥着重要作用，并在其后期著作中呈现出更为充实和具体的特征。这尤其始于《政治经济学批判大纲》，因为在此马克思将人类学的成果应用于其研究

more directly and to a greater extent than in his early work. Indeed, at the end of his life, Marx became interested in the work of American anthropologist Lewis Henry Morgan, and intended to write a treatment of Morgan's writings. Marx died before he could complete that project, a work Engels later adopted and published as *Origin of the Family, Private Property, and the State*. This gives us an indication of how Marx attempted to base his understanding of the individual on the results of science throughout his career. Marx's aim was to theorize concrete individuality based on the lived experiences of existing human beings, an improvement over the abstract, one-sided individual who, he charged, forms the subject of eighteenth-century philosophy (this is a theme to be taken up more fully in the following chapter, in which I discuss the concept of individuality in Marx's thought).

In the afterword to the second German edition of *Capital*, Marx describes his method of historical materialism:

My dialectic method is not only different from the Hegelian, but is its direct opposite. To Hegel, the life process of the human brain, i.e., the process of thinking, which, under the name of "the Idea," he even transforms into an independent subject, is the *demiurgos* of the real world, and the real world is only the external, phenomenal form of "the Idea." With me, on the contrary, the ideal is nothing else than the material world reflected by the human mind, and translated into forms of thought. . . . The mystification which dialectic suffers in Hegel's hands, by no means prevents him from being the first to present its general form of working in a comprehensive and conscious manner. With him it is standing on its head. It must be turned right side up again, if you would discover the rational kernel within the mystical shell.

In its mystified form, dialectic became the fashion in Germany, because it seemed to transfigure and to glorify the existing state of things. In its rational form it is a scandal and abomination to bourgeoisdom and its doctrinaire professors, because it includes in its comprehension an affirmative recognition of the existing state of things, at the same time also, the recognition of the negation of that state, of its inevitable breaking up; because it regards every historically developed social form as in fluid movement, and therefore takes into account its transient nature not less than its momentary existence; because it lets nothing impose upon it, and is in its essence critical and revolutionary.³⁴

比其早期著作更为直接和广泛。事实上，在生命晚期，马克思对美国人类学家路易斯·亨利·摩根的著作产生了兴趣，并打算撰写一部关于摩根著作的论述。马克思在未能完成该项目前便去世了，后来恩格斯采纳并出版了该工作，题为《家庭、私有制和国家的起源》。这为我们提供了马克思在其整个职业生涯中如何试图将对个人的理解建立在科学成果之上的线索。马克思的目标是基于现存人类的生活经验来理论化具体的个体性，这是对抽象的、片面的个人的改进，而后者被他指责为十八世纪哲学的主题（这一主题将在下一章中更充分地展开，其中我将讨论马克思思想中的个体性概念）。

在《资本论》第二版德文版跋中，马克思描述了他的历史唯物主义方法：

我的辩证法与黑格尔式的辩证法不仅不同，而且是其直接对立面。对黑格尔而言，人脑的生命过程，即思维过程，被他以“理念”之名转化为独立主体，成为现实世界的造物主，而现实世界仅仅是“理念”的外在现象形式。反之，对我来说，观念不过是物质世界在人脑中反映并转化为思维形式的结果。……辩证法在黑格尔手中所受到的神秘化，丝毫不能阻止他成为第一个以全面且有意识的方式阐述其一般工作形式的人。在他那里，它是头足倒置的。若要发现其神秘外壳中的理性内核，就必须将其倒转过来。

在其神秘化形式上，辩证法在德国成为时尚，因为它似乎能够转化并美化现存的事物状态。在其理性形式上，它对资产阶级社会及其教条主义教授来说是丑闻和可憎的，因为它在理解中既包含对现存事物状态的肯定性认识，同时也包含对这一状态的否定、对其必然崩溃的认识；因为它将每一个历史上形成的社会形式都视为处于流动的运动之中，因此它不仅考虑到其暂时性，也考虑到其暂时的存在；因为它不容许任何事物蒙蔽自己，在其本质上它是批判的和革命的。³⁴

The critics who charge Marx with economic determinism attack him, by and large, for failing to conjure up in thought what does not already exist in reality—a world of human beings who act entirely freely, and a human society that allows ways of living undetermined by narrow economic pressures and interests. Marx does not offer that illusion or otherwise indulge the ideological demand for it.

What is necessary and inevitable is the impermanence of the existing state of things, but not what will replace it, assuming that human society actually does continue to exist and develop in the long term. Of course, it might not. But already to suggest that capitalism cannot go on forever is itself “critical and revolutionary,” as Marx points out. It holds out the possibility that the existing state of things might be cast away in favor of something new, and for human intervention into the “fluid movement” of history. It is the certainty of such movement that allows Marx to conceive of a further development of the human individual.

Such a development can only occur upon an economic basis that has not yet been developed, just as the full freedom of the human person can only exist in a society in which “the free development of each is the condition for the free development of all,” a society that has not yet been produced. In reading Marx as a crude economic determinist who cannot account for human freedom, his critics reveal only a very shallow engagement with the complexity of Marxist thought. Even while Marx refuses to attribute a range of freedom to human beings that does not yet exist in capitalist society, he sees how that sphere of freedom can be expanded upon a new economic base. A new and more robust freedom can be brought about through the activity of conscious human actors, leveraging existing social processes to achieve their goal.

指责马克思持有经济决定论的批评家们，大体上攻击他未能从思想中构想出现实中尚不存在的东西——一个完全自由行动的人类世界，以及一个不受狭隘经济压力和利益决定的生活方式的人类社会。马克思并未提供这种幻觉，也未纵容这种意识形态上的需求。

必要且不可避免的是现存状态的无常，而非其替代品是什么，前提是人类社会确实在长期内继续存在和发展。当然，它也可能不会。但正如马克思所指出的，仅仅暗示资本主义不能永远持续下去本身就是“批判性和革命性的”。它提出了这样一种可能性：现有的状态可以被抛弃，转而采用某种新事物，并允许人类干预历史的“流动运动”。正是这种运动的确定性使马克思能够构想人类的进一步发展。

这种发展只能在一个尚未发展的经济基础之上发生，正如人类的完全自由只能存在于这样一个社会中：“每个人的自由发展是一切人自由发展的条件”，而这样一个社会尚未被创造出来。将马克思读作无法解释人类自由的粗糙经济决定论者的批评者，仅仅暴露了他们对马克思主义思想复杂性的浅薄理解。即使马克思拒绝将人类尚未在资本主义社会中拥有的某种自由归因于人类，他也看到了这种自由领域如何能在新的经济基础之上得以扩展。一种新的、更强大的自由可以通过自觉的人类行动者的活动来实现，利用现有的社会过程以达到他们的目标。